

FRACTURED MINDs

A quest for clarity in a confusing world

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“Life isn’t about finding yourself.
Life is about creating yourself.”
-George Bernard Shaw.

INTRODUCTION

In light of the new world, we are about to live in is influenced by a lot of things like Artificial Intelligence and growing fears around social aspects like relationships, in economics unemployment seems to be coming in hard in the future and we are yet to find our path to a sustainable life on earth. Compared to how we found it, the world is getting confusing for many people including myself.

The cognitive dissonance of all these technological developments like AI is quite overwhelming. And of course, our minds are naturally programmed to be survivors in the past we ran away from dangerous animals or found ways to survive hard environments to ensure our survival in this world, and this is kicking in right now as people's survival is being threatened by unemployment, but a few years back in 2020 we had the Corona Virus pandemic which pushed people into lockdowns and many months in people began to miss each other the physical interaction that they had with friends, partners, and family. We witnessed many deaths which spiked a reminder of our numbered days in this world and made us grateful for the gift of life we had.

A few years later 2023 OpenAI released ChatGPT a chatbot that takes the internet by storm and later we have this entire AI race between companies competing to build the best AI models to meet customer needs and of course, capitalize from some features to make a profit, then a new question comes up "Will AI take our jobs?" which creates a fear of unemployment in the future raising questions on how will we meet our financial needs? Is Universal Basic Income the solution here?

In the political sphere, tensions are rising in quite a magnitude, Russia invaded Ukraine, Israel is in tensions with Iran and, mob riots in the UK, and Trump faced an assassination attempt that failed! It's like chaos everywhere recently, and the impacts of these events are critical to the future.

It's becoming even harder to know what is the right thing to do in your life, let alone all the good self-help books out there, we face different situations and very complex decisions that completely have different answers depending on the brain models we have at the time of making the choice.

We have no choice but to learn to develop the right mental model that is for use, one that is supported by logical thinking which only comes from developing clarity on the subject and being honest with ourselves and what we want for our lives. And this calls for bravery in the new world, trusting your choices, and creating your paths.

PART ONE

THE WANDERING CHILD

CHAPTER 1

NATURAL SELECTION

Our existence in the world is influenced by nature, but how we live in this world is a choice that is up to us.

No one chooses to be born in the families they're born in or to be conceived from the parents they have, I didn't choose to be Sweya nor did I choose to be Galanda it was merely a name that was given to me by my parents after birth inherited from my grandpa Galanda Andrea Ngusa.

WHERE DID WE COME FROM?

Scientists would carry out investigations to know the origin of the earth, and how it emerged to how it is today, many theories out there carry different speculations on how humans even came to existence. Others believe in the fact that humans evolved from apes as suggested by Charles Darwin in his book *The Origin of Species*. And there are many other theories out there, but one that has prevailed more in me is the one of creation, where God a powerful entity created the world and everything that is in it.

It's hard for me personally to believe that the earth and the galaxies were merely made from some sort of accidental force that just came from nowhere considering how precise the structure of the earth is, and its unique ability to support human life. Hopefully, if Musk makes it to Mars, we could be terrestrial organisms.

But again, framing around this very origin of our existence is where all the cycles of what have been motivating us in this world spark from. To understand what your life is you need to first understand what your origin is, and find purpose in your existence.

I was born in a Christian family it is evident that I adopted the creation version of the origin of the earth. As kids, we don't have enough information in our brains to think logically and perform critical thinking or reasoning on any subject matter. And so, with this, every new idea that is presented to us is readily adopted or accepted and they develop into beliefs that are hard for us to question later even when convincing evidence is presented to us because we build our entire lives around these beliefs in such a way, they even shape our lifestyles.

I remember the first time the teacher mentioned the evolution theory, it was completely disturbing because then we would have to use it to answer questions in examinations, which ended up being knowledge just to fill up on an examination paper because it conflicted with the belief that I had carried, but while I was in advanced level, a friend of mine mentioned how science and God were two sides of the same coin, and clarified that some of the very things that could've created the earth could've been of the result of the science that God created, especially the cosmos theories which explain how the world came to existence, but still hesitated on men evolution from apes cause they're no longer changing into men.

Either belief you choose to go with it's up to you because it depends on the theories you have heard or come across and the strength of the evidence that backed them up, of course from a religious stance, creation would be the standing theory, and if you are an atheist than it could be one of the other theories. But this book is not intended to clear this dilemma or answer this complex question of existence, my target is to navigate through life in this world, which thankfully we visualize physically and can have more impact on it. We can develop conscious ideas of it which shape the way we live in it.

HOW DOES NATURAL SELECTION INFLUENCE OUR LIVES?

Natural selection has a significant impact on our lives. Understanding how it shapes the world around us and influences our traits and behaviors can provide valuable insights into human development.

In many cases, we sometimes compare ourselves with other humans, we compare our social, economic, or political status with other people, sometimes it's an upward comparison towards the more popular or more influential people we see in the community which sometimes makes us ungrateful for what we have and again sometimes we perform downward comparisons which seems to be more comforting that we are at a better position. But in all cases, it's useless and doesn't help you prove anything, we are born under different circumstances which place us in barriers or advantageous positions that other people do not have access to.

One of the conversations I would have with some of my peers would be on finding a way to make it to developed countries in search of better lives and favorable conditions to work our dream careers and potentially build the things we anticipated to build to ultimately reach the financial freedom we aspire to get. This of course would be the case when some of my colleagues and I began searching for international scholarships after finishing high school, to get these golden opportunities that we believed could make a life difference for us but my mom would consistently tell me that you can still succeed from where you are. This is what influences the migrations people make to foreign countries in search of refuge and more favorable conditions to meet their financial needs.

Of course, when it comes to achieving things, there are just some things that you can't achieve without having certain factors, or resources playing by your side and geographical location can highly influence these things. Building a tech company for example comes with many challenges in Tanzania some influenced by the policies that the country has compared to building one in the USA, it's achievable but the efforts required to make it a success are not the same, in Tanzania you will face more changes compared to USA. However, in comparison to South Sudan where there is currently a civil war, you stand a better chance of making it happen from Tanzania, but the South Sudan men's national basketball team is ranked as the 33rd national basketball team in the world and Tanzania being positioned at 148th position as of the 1st of March, 2024 and of course the USA tops the Men's basketball teams rankings.

Everyone has goals or achievements that they want to achieve in life, others call them dreams once you tell other people they could see you as a fantasy dream machine, but ultimately your goals could require small efforts to reach or extreme efforts and dedication and, in some cases, no matter the effort you apply it just won't work, so it's important to try to make clear research and critical thinking round your ideas.

So, if you ever get the chance of having geographical mobility in your favor, I recommend using it. Travel to whatever place you can to both gain experience and exposure, don't just do it for leisure, some experiences can help open you up to challenges that could require your skills to be solved and build a business around them. And of course, be open to connecting with more people and building networks that can later help or aid you in creating more career opportunities for yourself.

NATURAL SELECTION AND SUCCESS.

A lot of people in this world have been successful in the years, including you of course making it to this minute was not easy. But there are a few people who have managed to reach the climax of success that others have not been able to reach. There are millions of companies in the world but few of them nail the market and drive everything, and even in other industries a few players manage to make it to the top spots. Lionel Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo have been crowned as the Greatest Players of All Time alongside other players like Pele, Maradona, Roberto Carlos, and many other talents that played in the sport. But they're not the only players who were in training there could be other players who have been training even harder than them and sometimes even had more talent than them but lacked something that didn't put them in higher positions same as them. I speak of these players because to me personally obsessed with football. But that was something that only they could do because of what was built in them.

I remember telling one of my friends about Benjamin Fernandes the founder of Nala who had inspired me to be a startup founder from Tanzania, which gave me the belief that I too could pull out something like that, then the response that came back to me was a bit daunting. He asked, "Which university did he go to?" and I responded "Stanford Graduate School of Business, I also heard he went to Harvard on Millard Ayo's YouTube channel" and he said "Yeah that explains why" It hit me the deep as if a Tanzanian who just studied at a local University in the country couldn't reach the same heights as Benjamin, of course, he did take interest on him onwards and we consistently kept follow of him with his work with Nala which was quite an amazing technology. He simply said, "The environment that he studied around helped him get that, those universities help make them thinkers and problem solvers and develop businesses around their solutions to these problems." This insight brought me into realization, it made me realize just why most of the top innovators of my generation and the previous ones have emerged from USA soil, all the top billionaires are there, most of the higher valued companies were founded there and exist there but not everyone is there builds them, it's specific people there could've been people who went to the same schools as Benjamin or even better but didn't develop that network or eye to come up with Nala.

You can even recall when you started school, at the very lower tier of kindergarten a lot of kids get enrolled but up the ladder to university levels and beyond to being professors in the same batch or group the number drops drastically, some people find the ladder to steep or pointless and pursue other things like business or decide to be entrepreneurs, and others end up having nothing in life. And even the ones who start businesses not all of them turn into a success, some of the businesses fail and they move to another thing that can support them.

This made me think, are there people who are just born to be better than others to have the ability to be favored in certain positions and get what other people are not getting out of life? And it is the truth but I believe everyone is born with a talent that could serve them well in life, but sadly few people acknowledge their talents, but hard work and discipline can accelerate you further into a person who is incomparable to other people. That's why Messi and Ronaldo are very different from other players.

The biblical "Parable of the Talents" (Matthew 25:14-30) offers one perspective. In this story, a master entrusts his property to three servants based on their abilities: five talents to one, two to another, and one to the third. Upon the master's return, he finds that the first two servants have multiplied their talents, while the third simply buried his. This parable is often interpreted as a lesson on the importance of using one's God-given abilities productively.

Similarly, Islamic teachings emphasize the significance of utilizing one's talents. The Quran, in Surah Al-Baqarah, verse 286, stresses the importance of using one's abilities and resources to their fullest capacity, while also taking responsibility for the consequences of one's actions. In Islam, it's believed that

Allah has bestowed unique talents upon each individual, which should be used for personal betterment and societal progress.

Regardless of one's religious beliefs or lack thereof—be it atheist, agnostic, or any other worldview—there seems to be a universal understanding of the value of talents. Each person possesses unique abilities that others may lack, highlighting the importance of working harmoniously to serve each other's needs. This mutual exchange of talents can lead to personal growth and societal development.

For instance, a highly talented athlete can use their income to improve community facilities or infrastructure. An innovative engineer can create solutions that enhance the quality of life for many. It's through the application of our unique talents that we often find purpose in life and make meaningful contributions to the world around us.

This perspective on talents offers a nuanced view of success. While external factors like luck undoubtedly play a role, the cultivation and application of one's innate abilities emerge as crucial elements in achieving personal fulfillment and positively impacting others.

I often struggled to identify my talent. This was challenging because people frequently emphasized the importance of knowing one's talents to make informed life choices. I discovered that many others shared this difficulty.

One day, I came across a website listing various talents

(<https://www.bryndonovan.com/2021/07/26/a-list-of-125-talents-and-skills-for-characters/>).

Surprisingly, many listed items were skills I hadn't previously considered talents. This realization highlighted how the definition of talent can be confusing for many. Simply put, a talent could be defined as something you excel at that others find challenging. If you can use this ability to benefit yourself and others or build a strong career around it, it's worth pursuing.

YOU MAY NOT BE TALENTED LIKE EVERYONE ELSE, BUT YOU CAN LEARN THE SKILLS THEY HAVE AND USE THEM TO REACH YOUR DREAMS AS WELL.

Nike's commercial for the 2024 Olympic Games, with the tagline "Winning isn't for everyone", while it showcased top athletes using their equipment. But keep in mind winners lose and winners are made as well, they work hard to be who they are. In life's reality: we'll face both victories and defeats in our challenges, as there will always be people more skilled than us in certain areas. However, this doesn't mean we should give up. Instead, we should learn from our failures and find ways to achieve personal success.

The rivalry between tennis legends Roger Federer and Rafael Nadal illustrates this point. Federer was once considered unbeatable, consistently winning against Nadal. However, Nadal worked on improving his game and eventually defeated Federer. Despite their intense on-court rivalry, they maintained a friendship off the court. This demonstrates how competition can coexist with mutual respect and even friendship.

In essence, recognizing and developing our talents is crucial, but so is understanding that success isn't always about winning. It's about continuous improvement, learning from setbacks, and maintaining positive relationships even in competitive environments.

CHAPTER 2

THE WORLD BEYOND

I found the old world and walked into a new world, one that made me miss the old one.

Born with unconsciousness we live months in this world till our brain develops the ability to learn about the environment we are in, and we begin to develop the software in our brain. After the birth of my nephew Azariah which was quite an amazing experience for me because I wasn't comfortable around babies, but this time I felt an amazing energy flowing whenever I was around him or saw his pictures, I wish I could call it love, but I find the term not matching to what I am expressing.

In just four months, the kid began living a baby's dream thanks to his good parents, eating, sleeping, and showering was his routine at the top he even rarely cried and was so polite, and growing up he would slowly study his environment and of course, babies need good parental care to help them grow in comfort. I remember one day my sister sending a pic of him trying so hard to crawl out of his little sleeping pouch, but couldn't quite articulate his organs to do it.

This experience amused me cause it sort of reflected how human beings behave generally when we are infants but we are not aware of it because we're not conscious of what is going on. And so, I began to question myself where does all this curiosity go? When we grow up suddenly, we just find ourselves living in structures or paths already created for us by people, and few people manage to break out and keep on with their curiosity in pursuit of the answers they want to know.

I strongly believe that the core of our strength lies in the abilities that we are born with, that sometimes we don't get to find out because we get so caught up in whatever other people are doing in this world, and forget to focus on developing ourselves. This even made me question my time in school when I was about to graduate High School, I asked myself why I went down the hole for 13 years learning things that in the end I wouldn't even be able to apply in life, what if I could've only focused with what I found more living in me from the beginning?

THE PARADIGM CONCEPT

A paradigm is essentially a mental framework or model that shapes how we perceive and understand the world. It's a set of assumptions, beliefs, and values that guide our thinking and actions. Think of it as a lens through which we view reality. About thinking, a paradigm influences the following:

- **What we consider possible:** It determines what we believe can and cannot be done.
- **How we solve problems:** Our approach to problem-solving is often shaped by our existing paradigms.
- **The questions we ask:** Our paradigms influence the kinds of questions we seek answers to.

From the above explanations I believe we are getting somewhere to understand how we live, I put this under this chapter because our world is what builds our paradigm. You can define the world as; planet Earth, Humanity, or the Universe which is complex including all space, time, matter, and energy but here I am referring to humanity the entire human population that you interact with every day. For instance, if you have grown up in an Islamic, Buddhist, or Christian family, it's obvious there are certain perspectives of life that you would find very different when you met with someone out of your religious sphere. Paradigms about sex and relationships are shaped not only by religion but also heavily influenced by culture. In the modern era, the internet, globalization, and social media play significant roles in forming people's perspectives. For example, in many African tribal cultures, sex has traditionally been viewed as exclusively for married couples—a perspective I observed in my parents and community.

However, contemporary pop culture, amplified by global connectivity, promotes a more liberal approach to sexuality. This shift has led to sexual relationships becoming more common at younger ages and sex being viewed as less sacred compared to traditional values.

Paradigms are deeply ingrained mental frameworks, programmed into our brains from an early age. Even as we gain education and absorb new information, these fundamental paradigms continue to guide our thinking. This explains why, despite millions of people holding advanced degrees in various academic fields, only a few manage to make significant impacts with their knowledge. This disconnect has led many to question the value of traditional education.

Growing up, I believed that formal education was my ticket to a successful life. I aspired to attend university and earn a degree that would unlock high-paying job opportunities. However, my perspective shifted when I encountered the reality of professional athletes, particularly football players, who earned substantial incomes without extensive formal education. This realization made me question the purpose of my schooling. As a result, my enthusiasm for education waned, and I found myself pursuing good grades primarily to please my parents rather than for personal fulfillment or growth.

This experience led me to admire individuals who have developed unique paradigms for problem-solving and success. Take Elon Musk, for example. Among the successful people I know—Jeff Bezos, Sir Jeff, Benjamin Fernandes, Pep Guardiola, and countless others—Musk stands out for his approach to complex challenges that many would dismiss as impossible.

Musk's achievement in building SpaceX, a private company that regularly launches rockets into space with the ambitious goal of extending human presence to Mars, exemplifies this paradigm. While some kids outgrow their childhood dreams of space exploration as later, they become deemed to seem unrealistic, Musk held onto his and made it a reality. He attributes his success to "First Principles" thinking—breaking down complex problems into their most fundamental elements and building solutions from there.

This approach has driven the success of Musk's various ventures, often in the face of skepticism and against significant odds. The breakthroughs and massive achievements of such innovators can't be attributed solely to knowledge or education. Instead, they stem from well-developed mental models that allow these individuals to navigate novel and challenging situations.

The risk-taking and innovative thinking demonstrated by these successful figures highlight a crucial point: while traditional education provides a foundation, it's the ability to think creatively, take calculated risks, and persevere in the face of skepticism that often leads to groundbreaking success. This realization challenges us to reconsider not just the value of formal education, but also how we approach problem-solving and personal growth in our own lives.

PARADIGM SHIFT

Paradigm shifts occur when a new way of thinking radically changes how we understand something. These shifts can be revolutionary and often lead to significant advancements. So, you can develop a new paradigm by breaking the old one you had after coming to a clear understanding of the reality of things which happens from generation to generation as we come across new technologies and realizations that make us adopt new paradigms to keep it intact with what we find right.

It is not my intention to overhaul your paradigm, probably you might be very confident with the mental model you already have, but I would like to shed light on helping you find a way to build your paradigm one that is of your free choice without being pushed by someone to allow you to live a life that is free of the bias locking that society tries to push us into.

A SHORT JOURNEY

I was born in Tanzania, in the region of Mwanza, specifically in the Magu district at the Bulima Dispensary. Of course, I have nothing but pictures of that moment, and I don't clearly remember when I first gained consciousness of who I was. I found myself living in a village called Bulima*, which was quite nice. It wasn't densely populated, with just enough people to make it easy to know everyone.

I made a couple of friends and enjoyed their company a lot. When I was about seven years old, my parents were often away. My mom was in university, and my dad was working as a pastor, so I grew up in an extended family. It was me, my two cousins, and my sister, and I was the youngest. My cousins, who were already teenagers, had lost their father at a very young age, so my parents took them in. In this environment, I thought my aunt was my actual mom, and my cousins were my siblings.

My mom would come home during her breaks, but for some reason, we called her "Mom Senior." I never really understood why, but I went along with it. She once told me that I had said to her in Swahili, "Bye Mom Senior, I'm going to go back to my real mom now." She took it well because she believed I was in good hands.

I tried to make sense of our daily life: waking up, doing chores, napping, playing in the evening with limited time, taking a shower, and finally going to sleep. Sometimes my childhood felt empty because I rarely did what I liked. I only enjoyed playing with my friends, so the day had its boring hours and fun hours. This made me love the time from 4 p.m. until nightfall, and I hated the rest of the day.

On Fridays, I started going to my friend's homeschool, where his mom taught us English from a massive book. She helped me improve my English. After my sister's disastrous performance in her English exams, my parents introduced a house rule: we had to speak English at home to help us keep up in school and to assist them with their university lessons. My friend's mom taught me only on Fridays. Sometimes I didn't want to go, but it was hard to resist the snacks and her delicious baking.

Later, I started kindergarten, and a year later, primary school. I didn't enjoy the classes; they were quite tiring for me. But saying this to my parents was hard for fear of getting a whooping. Hahaa. One of my aunts from my dad's side would strip off my top clothes, leaving me in my underwear, and unleash a serial whooping on my butt. The marks served as a lesson, preaching, "DON'T DO IT AGAIN."

Growing up in Bulima gave me a diversified experience of life, as I navigated between foreign cultures and my own native culture. Missionaries from the USA and Canada resided in the village, running a biblical college called Nassa Theological College. Occasionally, the missionaries had friends visit, often bringing their kids along. This gave us a chance to connect with them. One of the strangest things to me was how kids like me were only grounded after they made a mistake. It made me question my society's approach to dealing with mistakes. It was from here where I developed the idea that Africa did everything wrong and that's why it was far under developed compared to the foreign developed countries.

The missionaries also installed the internet in a few homes in the village and had computers hooked up to the internet at the college's library, though few people used them. I remember the first time I ever used the internet. I was home alone with my dad, and he gave me his Dell laptop to play with. I had used a computer before with my cousin Andrew, who had shown me how to use it early on, and I continued exploring it on my own. I opened Chrome and remember the first thing I searched for was Manchester City.

At the time, I saw the internet as a place for entertainment. I spent enormous amounts of time playing games on miniclip.com with my sister's IBM PC. Sometimes an entire day would go by without me eating, as I was glued to the computer. One day, I accidentally locked the firmware on my sister's IBM. When she came home from school, she was deadly furious, but she eventually got over it.

I wasn't quite the bundle of joy; I was quite the rascal and caused a lot of problems for my parents. The peak of my worst behavior came when one of our family friends left their house keys at our home. I took the keys and, accompanied by two of my friends, went to their house. We ate the food in their

fridge, played with their bathtubs, and messed around in their rooms. Of course, we also messed with Max, their cat but kindly we made sure he didn't go out of the house.

Then came their gardener, who noticed one of us—David—and shouted, “What are you kids doing in there?” Pawpaw and I ran away, leaving David behind, who went back home, which was literally the neighboring house. I went to Pawpaw's house to chill until my sister came looking for me.

The walk back home was a bitter one as I asked myself what would be done to me. When I arrived, I found my aunt waiting with a stick. She punished me (*I hope you get how African mothers can turn the crank when it comes to beating their kids*), grounding me for a month and not allowing me to see any of my friends. To be honest, getting grounded was depressing—sticks made the process fast and painful, but being grounded dragged the punishment out. I had to apologize to the family I had wronged, I wonder if Max was angry too—it's hard to win a cat's love; they always push away. This stunt pushed my parents to move closer to me, so in 2014, I moved to Dar Es Salaam to live with them. I missed the friends I left behind, but I managed to make new ones.

I was less of a rascal here because now my parents had full parental control over me. And yeah, there were so many bad things happening to kids in the streets at night—like kidnappings and a gang called 'Panya Road' that caused havoc in the streets of Dar. Of course, no kid wants to die and leave behind all the things they still wish for like CATS*. This time I was more restricted, spending more time at home to avoid causing trouble. But I still got into trouble. My dad punished me many times for leaving my room dirty or lying, which was ugly because he would immediately catch me in the lie—I was terrible at lying.

I rarely got along with my sister, and we would fight from time to time, which also got me into trouble. My sister was quite the good child that every parent wished for, and I was the bad kid. So, any misunderstanding with her led to a whooping from my parents, except from my mom, who didn't use a broom or a stick but instead pinched me with her fingernails somewhere around my ribs. It was painful and left marks.

As a kid, sometimes you just do stuff without knowing the consequences, and being punished for your mistakes time and time again could make you feel unloved because you're the only one running into problems. I recall my dad punishing me to the point where he got tired and decided to stop because it was causing him shoulder pain. He told me he was never going to punish me again and would let me suffer the consequences of my actions.

He said this when I was about ten years old, but he didn't keep his word and continued punishing me for my wrongdoings, which never seemed to stop. Sometimes I ask myself why I was such a stubborn kid and didn't just listen (but you realize that's a lie, right?). No kid does that unless it's in a movie. I did feel guilty at times for my mistakes, but I wasn't fully aware of myself. I did wish I could be more like my childhood friend LJ, who was always the model for what I should have done when I messed up, and my parents would often refer to him—guess I was the bird who didn't fly with other birds of the same flock!

My parents looked for numerous ways to fix my behavior and make me a good kid, but every method seemed to fail. Luckily for them, the victims of my bad behavior were them, and not other families or kids, so there were fewer casualties. While in Dar, I rarely enjoyed playing with toys. My parents' computers were fun to play with, and I enjoyed playing games on them whenever I got the chance—except for Microsoft Solitaire. That game just didn't sync well with my brain and felt boring, and chess too, especially when you played against the computer. I often wondered how it was able to think of moves on its own.

Not long after, in the same year, we moved to Dodoma after my mom got an opportunity to study for her PhD. This is where the old bad kid that I was began to change, thanks to the even stricter rules my parents imposed on me. They even kept me from going outside the house gate to play with other kids. But it didn't work in the long run; I just couldn't stay in one place for long, so I had to sneak out of the house to play with other kids. And WOW! Guess what? One day as we played football outside, one of the kids kicked a ball that went over the house fence and hit a window. I carried some blame for that as well.

DREAMS AND IMAGINATIONS

According to Google's English dictionary, provided by Oxford Languages, imagination is the faculty or action of forming new ideas, images, or concepts of external objects not present to the senses. Our imagination can stem from past experiences or be shaped by environments we creatively construct in our minds.

Almost every kid develops different imaginations about their future or what they wish to become, often inspired by things they see on TV or in books. For me, YouTube was a major source of wonder during my childhood. Every day, I discovered new things that captured my attention—especially airplanes, which made me dream of being a pilot. That is until my uncle Fred told me that pilots could be replaced by robots in the future and planes might fly themselves. That was quite disappointing.

Many of us have dreams about the things we hope to build or own in the future, but reality often presents barriers that discourage these ideas. Sometimes, our imaginations can be a bit unrealistic, but they're still important. My uncle suggested that instead of becoming a pilot, I should aim to be an aerospace engineer, so I could build airplanes and even fly them. At first, I experienced cognitive dissonance because I had spent so much time imagining myself as a pilot, landing airplanes at Nyerere International Airport in Dar Es Salaam. I even dreamed of working for huge airlines like Emirates. But when that dream was cut short, I began imagining myself as an aerospace engineer, fixing and building airplanes that stood as engineering marvels.

That dream didn't last long either. My mom told me it would be hard to study aerospace engineering in our country and suggested that I pursue something computer-related, which I was at least good at and had a promising job market. Surprisingly, this suggestion resonated with me, and I dropped my dream of playing with airplanes.

My mom's suggestion was a bit ironic because I had crashed both her computer and my dad's computer so many times that the blue screen of death was a familiar sight. As a result, I was banned from using their computers repeatedly, but after two weeks, they would forget, and I was back at it again. The cycle continued until one day I decided to fix the computers myself by learning from YouTube. However, this led to more problems, like losing all their files. I remember my mom lying on her bed one day, looking pale as if she had cried, asking me, "Did you fix it?" I would reply, "Yes, but the files are..." Her heart would break because she had her lectures saved on her computer, and here I was, telling her they were gone. My reckless behavior with the computer made my parents value backups.

They bought hard drives to protect their files from being completely lost when their computers crashed due to my actions. My mom even considered switching to a MacBook to escape the problem for good. I'm sorry, Microsoft—I made my mom lose faith in your operating system, but don't worry, she still uses your email services, so it's not all bad.

Despite all this, I never thought I would consider a career involving computers, but eventually, I did. Dreams and imaginations change every day as we wake up to reality. They are limited by what we know or understand to be true, but sometimes emotional ties keep us attached to dreams that are too unrealistic. We might imagine living the lives of people we see on social media, hungering for the material things they enjoy.

But never underestimate the power of imagination and dreaming big. Some of the greatest inventions we use today were once the products of powerful imaginations. The world we see today is the result of imagination, and even greater ideas are propelling us toward a more advanced future. Artificial Intelligence, for instance, lived in many people's minds as early as 1950 when Alan Turing introduced it by publishing "Computer Machinery and Intelligence", but we are seeing its peak now, developed by entirely different people along the way like Sam Altman, Geoffrey Hinton, and Mark Zuckerberg.

One of the priests at my secondary school in Dodoma, John Merlin, said, "Share your dreams and they will live; if you hide them from others, they will die." I believe this means sharing your dreams with the right people and understanding the fundamental truths around them. One of the greatest

imaginations today is Elon Musk's dream of taking humanity to Mars—a dream that seemed impossible, but he has made people believe it could happen.

Spaceships and space exploration have long been the dreams of many, and though speaking them out loud once sounded crazy, they are becoming more realistic. So don't stop dreaming or imagining. Hold onto them, share them with the right people, and break them down to their fundamentals to understand how they can become reality.

MISSING THE OLD WORLD

It's as if the more the days go, the world seems to get more confusing and even more different compared to the way we found it, the world has been moving so fast that what is known by a 20-year-old today will be known to a 15-year-old in the future, you can literally see how kids quickly know how to use smartphones these days, which were once known to only a few individuals of higher ages.

And technological advances have always shaped the way we live, every incremental change has far spread impacts to our social lives as well, and even influencing some social patterns in our communities. And as Ray Kurzweil put it in the Law of Accelerating Returns with the idea that technological progress accelerates exponentially, rather than incrementally.

In simple means, he means that technology change is going to get faster as years progress. The magnitude of the changes you are seeing today are only going to get faster to extent where changes that seemed like years of change will only be like days of change in the future, and thus the world will look very different in the coming years and of course it will even get stranger the more time flies by.

Growing up, social media wasn't a very common thing even though the internet was there I rarely used it to communicate with people at the young age, and I recall opening my first social media account on Facebook in 2013, of course it wasn't hard to say you were 18 back then, but again I didn't use it to communicate with anyone cause I knew no one who used it at the time and I abandoned my account, so physical communication was more prominent in my life.

And then fast forward many years into 2024, only 11 years later and my phone is filled with more than 100 contacts with classmates from primary school to advanced level, relatives and the many different people I have met in different places. And yet I would rarely even contact these people and now social media is like the center for communication with many of my peers and less physical communication.

And as wild as it sounds, most of the kids I see today spend most of their time indoors and not outdoors. I recall enjoying going outside time to time, and climbing the two hills in the village and of course coming across snakes and weird animals which created an adrenaline rush and ran if alone or attack the threat when accompanied with friends, but all these experiences are lost to the kids born in the modern new world.

It's always been a social topic on how the society has lost its moral or values, with the blame majorly being on social media, and of course the internet at scale a technology that I didn't really deem that dangerous when I was still a little kid. And of course, the "Generation Z" has been under a lot of criticism for being the most lost generation with lost values and even acknowledgment of the so-called "old ways" that have been justified for human beings to live, and I agree our generation has seemed to lose a lot of things especially on the general perspective of life, but the question is- who created the world Gen-Z are living in the first place? Aren't we living in a world created by the generation we have succeeded.

But social problems can never be solved by focusing on the person as they are just a result of the actual causative of the problem. And social media causes problems that are being addressed every day and here we are as there seems to be diminished chances of a better world than that we see now.

And of course, I don't see social media or the internet being taken down anytime in the future in response to all these problems, so it's up to you to navigate through these problems and build your own solid way around it which we'll see in the chapters to come.

CHAPTER 3

GROWING DOUBTS

"Doubt is the origin of wisdom." - René Descartes

As we grow up, we start to question the world around us. Where we come from plays a big role in shaping these questions. We often find ourselves wondering why we don't have what others do and trying to match our imaginations with reality—sometimes, it just doesn't make sense.

I remember watching movies and thinking I could fly like Superman. My relatives had to convince me that it was all just Computer-Generated Imagery (CGI). That's when I started to question what was real and what wasn't. I remember trying to imitate movies and ask myself if I could actually fly like Superman just because I saw it on a film, and here my relatives convince me that it is just a Computer-Generated Image (CGI) and thus it's true. Then comes the question of what you're told is actually true.

THE COVER

Life wasn't easy for my parents. They were working hard to create a good life for themselves and us, their kids. But when I was around nine years old, I didn't see that. They made sure I was happy and didn't have to worry about anything. I want to give a shout-out to all the parents who work tirelessly to ensure their children are comfortable, despite their own struggles. My parents did that for me, and I'm incredibly grateful. For over 20 years, they've made sure I never missed a meal or went without my basic needs, showing me the true power of love. But now, let's talk about some of the darker realities... It's heartbreaking that some kids grow up without parents. I visited two orphanages during school tours in secondary school—one in Form One and another after I finished Form Four as part of a thanksgiving event organized by my classmates. These visits touched me deeply. Orphanages can't provide everything these kids need, and they often face life's harsh realities without the full support of parents. They're aware of their circumstances, which can be tough.

One day in high school, a caretaker at an orphanage near our school told us about how some university students have children they can't care for and end up abandoning them. She urged us to be responsible when we went to university, to help prevent these situations.

Some children are born into environments where their parents can't even provide basic needs, forcing them to find their own way. My parents often shared stories about their past. My dad came from a family with 14 kids, and their parents didn't have steady jobs or income to support everything, including education. Most of their food came from farming. Big dreams, like starting a company or solving life's problems, weren't on their minds—survival and meeting basic needs were. There's a concept called Maslow's hierarchy of needs, which is a theory about what drives our motivations. It goes from physiological needs like food and shelter to safety, love and belonging, esteem, and finally, self-actualization. My parents grew up focusing on getting their basic needs, and this influenced how they saw the world.

Education was hard for their parents to fully support and lived a shallow faith in how it could change their lives. My mom used to tell me how her father would struggle to give her pocket money for school, so she sometimes used leftover soap that other kids left behind to shower. Despite all this, she put in a lot of effort and carried quite the optimistic perception on education. Her story humbles me, reminding me to be grateful that I got a better education and environment than they did, all thanks to their guidance and love.

They took risks, not knowing the outcome but carrying faith in a better tomorrow something I tend to admire from the previous generations that we have succeeded. In his book *Happy Sexy Millionaire*,

Steven Bartlett expresses shock at how our generation seems more lost than previous ones, despite having more access to knowledge. Information and skills are readily available on the internet, in books and numerous sources, yet few are paying attention. This made me reflect on my parents and how they succeeded in life despite knowing so little of what to expect, compared to today's world where we have the chance to visualize what to expect in our future and make close to accurate predictions (*which go the other way sometimes*) on what can come out of our efforts and paths that we choose to take in life. We don't walk blindly like the past, though the predictions we make can't be taken as a guarantee because the world can change in a snap under influence of forces like pandemics which alter life choices and decisions.

BLURRED LINES

There's often a blurred line between reality and what we think about the world. It's confusing when something challenges our beliefs or understanding. This might not happen when we're kids, but it certainly happens at some point in life.

I remember playing with my cousin Andrew one evening. The moon was out, and he threw a rock at it. I heard a sound and thought he had actually hit the moon. He made me believe it was true, so at school, I told my classmates that my cousin could hit the moon with a rock. They laughed and called me a liar. I insisted it was true until I realized the moon was too far away to be hit by a rock. Then it hit me that there was a tree in the direction that the rock went, so the sound that I heard came from the tree that he had hit, and it was very precise because the tree was in a perfect alignment with the moon sight. This made me share less of my childhood stories and to prevent any further chances of looking like a clown, I made sure I did a bit of fact checking before I shared them with other people.

In my defense, I was clearly unaware of what it took to hit the moon with a rock from earth and had the wrong perception of the physics in that particular situation. When my cousin told me that he had thrown the rock to the moon, it was easy to believe him because I had no understanding of physics and of course I hadn't even heard of that word by then.

As kids, we often believe things that aren't true because we don't have enough knowledge to question them. Our truth depends on what we choose to believe. We might accept ideas or concepts from sources we trust, even if they aren't entirely accurate. For example, we might believe in magic or think that what happens in movies can happen in real life. But as we grow and learn more, these beliefs often change.

"Reality is what we take to be true. What we take to be true is what we believe. What we believe is based upon our perceptions. What we perceive depends upon what we look for. What we look for depends upon what we think. What we think depends upon what we perceive. What we perceive determines what we believe. What we believe determines what we take to be true. What we take to be true is our reality."

— Gary Zukav, *Dancing Wu Li Masters: An Overview of the New Physics*

It's a bit confusing, but take time to read it again and make sense of it, it can help change the way you accept concepts that are presented to you as realities or how you choose your truths in life. Our thoughts and beliefs evolve as we experience life. Doubts arise when we encounter something that contradicts what we believed to be true. This can be especially confusing for kids, who might begin to question who they should believe—whether it's their parents or someone else and your parents can't tell you everything of this world, other things will come to your discovery naturally, by peer pressure of other people or by your own following and looking into paths of life. It's critical to ensure that you make good sense of what comes and prevent yourself from conforming to things that won't be of any merit in your life. And don't be hard on yourself you won't make the best of decisions all the time.

PART TWO

THE AWAKENING

CHAPTER 4

A CONTRARIAN'S MIND

If you can identify a delusional popular belief, you can find what lies hidden behind it: the truth.

-Peter Thiel

A contrarian is someone who rejects or opposes popular opinions. Everyone thinks differently, leading to a variety of conflicting beliefs. Often, we support the majority opinion out of ignorance, which can result in confusion when reality doesn't meet our expectations. To live with clarity, you must be able to discern lies from the truth.

Lies can often facade as truth, especially when facts are manipulated, and delusions evolve into widely accepted beliefs. These beliefs can embed themselves in our minds and even become generational. During my teenage years and early adulthood, I encountered people with diverse perspectives on life, which made me question my own. High school marked a turning point where I began to reassess the narratives I'd held for so long.

Success and happiness are things we eagerly seek in life, but sometimes this pursuit leads us to accept ideas without questioning their validity. There are countless delusions about life, and people continue to be misled due to ignorance. To uncover the truth, it's essential to seek knowledge and understand issues in their entirety. This will help you make sound judgments when presented with new information. Remember, truth is shaped by what you choose to believe, and your beliefs are influenced by your perceptions.

To uncover the truths of the world, you must make a conscious effort to seek out accurate information, backed by evidence. Be open to analyzing both the positive and negative aspects of any situation. When something new is presented to you, research it or consult an expert. People may present ideas convincingly, but that should not be enough to conclude your beliefs—challenge those ideas. Desires can lead you to accept false information, which may take you in the wrong direction.

SCHOOL IS NOT EDUCATION

According to *Wikipedia*, A school is both the educational institution and building designed to provide learning spaces and learning environments for the teaching of students under the direction of teachers. On the other end, according to *Wikipedia*, Education is the transmission of knowledge, skills, and character traits and manifests in various forms. Education has existed since humanity's inception as a means of passing knowledge from one generation to the next, ensuring our survival.

Education has been a key driver of human development, bringing us to where we are today. Schools emerged as a method of delivering education to society. In the past, new generations relied on the preceding ones to pass down knowledge through informal methods. The scope of education depended on the experiences and knowledge that previous generations acquired. Schools, however, were intended to standardize this transmission of information. Today, education can be accessed from multiple sources, including the internet, with Artificial Intelligence possessing the potential to make it even easier to disseminate knowledge.

You can learn almost anything online with the right materials, focus, and a good roadmap, and AI can assist you in that process. However, our current systems are fixated on the idea that attending school and obtaining certificates are the primary means of gaining eligibility for work. Yet, your brain, not your certificate, will ultimately do the work. It's more important to focus on improving your mind than merely working toward a certificate.

One night in high school, during our night study session, a classmate wrote a timeline on the blackboard, mapping out our school years from primary school to high school—almost 13 years. We began to question how we had spent so many years in school, only to become adults without the skills to

manipulate our environments or create self-sufficient lives. I asked myself, what was the point of spending 13 years in school if I still lacked the eligibility to work or the skills to build a self-sustaining life?

This experience made me question the importance of school. Some may argue that the quality of education depends on the rank or level of the institution, like Harvard or Stanford, but not every successful person attended top universities—some even dropped out. This suggests that personal effort and intelligence are more significant factors. Attending a prestigious educational institution without putting in personal effort will get you nowhere.

To understand the phrase "SCHOOL IS NOT EDUCATION," consider the following:

1. **School** refers to a structured system of lessons, curricula, and credentials, while **education** encompasses a broader range of learning experiences, both inside and outside the classroom. The education system I experienced in Tanzania was too theoretical and rigid, leaving little room for exploration and curiosity, which are crucial for understanding our environment. Learning requires the freedom to fail, to explore complexities, and to build your own understanding—something that isn't encouraged in traditional schooling.
2. **Education** goes beyond merely acquiring information and passing exams, which is not an effective way to measure intelligence. I could recite facts memorized from notes but struggled to apply them in real life. Education should help us solve real-world problems and develop solutions for the future.
3. School has made education sound like something confined, where a person can attain full understanding of something or become competent in a field after they get the certificate at the end of the school year. But education lies in self-direction and lifelong learning, it shouldn't be confined to a specific time or place rather a continuous growth and discovery.
4. Classroom instruction alone isn't enough to provide a full understanding of how things work in the world. The world changes, and so do situations. Schools often lack significant learning through real-world experiences, hands-on activities, and immersion into diverse contexts, all of which add depth to the knowledge acquired.
5. School is not a one-size-fits-all solution, education has to be tailored to unique needs, interests and learning styles of each individual. Education should be your priority and focusing education on things of your interest is crucial to finding means to developing a lifetime good career. The more skills you have that other people need, the more you'll stand in a good position to earn from what you know.

While attending school is fundamental for many things in the world as the system is currently set up, it's important to remember that education extends beyond school and can be acquired from various sources. Keep an open mind to understanding how things work.

School grades may prove intelligence to some extent, but true intelligence lies in your ability to acquire and apply knowledge and skills. It's better to focus on gaining knowledge and skills that will improve your life and career.

SUCCESS IS SUBJECTIVE

Success is subjective and depends on what you value. For instance, when I was in secondary school, I believed that grades were everything—keys to success. Scoring good grades and being a top performer were my priorities because I wanted to make my parents happy. They would react joyfully when I told them I scored an A, but the happiness was short-lived. This led me to chase high grades, not for myself, but for the acceptance and admiration of others.

Back then, I equated success with excelling in class, getting a good job, earning a lot of money, buying a big house, and marrying. These were perspectives shaped by the society around me, and I adopted them as my own. We even expect happiness to come from achieving these forms of success.

In Advanced Level school, I initially aimed for high grades but ended up with D's, E's, and even an F in Physics and Mathematics. This failure diminished my drive for A's, and I settled for the modest grades I could manage. I chose to spend less time on traditional studying and more time on activities that could have a greater impact on my life. I began reading books and absorbing knowledge—something I had never enjoyed before. This shift happened after a conversation with a bookworm who effortlessly shared facts and insights I had never encountered. Our discussion made me realize how little I truly knew, and it humbled me, inspiring me to seek out more information through reading. I even tried to comment on some of the topics we were talking about and told me, “Don’t talk about something you don’t know about.”

Among the first books I read were *Zero to One* by Peter Thiel, *Diary of a CEO*, and *Happy Sexy Millionaire*, both by Steven Bartlett. These books transformed my view of careers and life in general. I began to ask myself what I could do to make my time on earth worthwhile. There's a lot of advice on how to live a meaningful life, but ultimately, the answer lies within you.

From that point on, I became less concerned with grades and more focused on developing my skills and mindset. I didn't stop studying; instead, I created a more effective study schedule with fewer hours but more impact. I focused on improving my weak points one by one, which helped me gradually raise my grades. The compounding effect is real—small improvements lead to significant gains over time. I first learned about this concept from *Atomic Habits* by James Clear, after the book worm recommended it. By making small improvements from exam to exam, I was able to achieve satisfying grades in the long run.

DON'T BE SOMEBODY ELSE

There are people we look up to in our lives—individuals who have achieved the success we aspire to attain. Sometimes, their life stories captivate us to the point where we feel a deep connection, inspiring us to follow in their footsteps. As a young person, I admired many billionaires and wished I could acquire their material wealth and public status.

Fame can be incredibly appealing, and we often overlook the hardships these individuals endured to get where they are. We see only their current success and tend to imitate the social media influencers who flaunt the lifestyles we desire. This can create confusion as we try to change who we are to be more like them, which is ultimately impossible.

You are completely unique. While you may share certain traits with others, no one is an exact replica of you—not even an identical twin. There is a significant difference between you and the people you consider your role models. It's not wrong to seek inspiration from others and adopt aspects of their lives that could benefit you, but the problem arises when you try to become exactly like them, chasing their status or competing with their achievements.

There will never be another Elon Musk, and there will never be another you. Focus on being yourself rather than imitating others, as it can lead to confusion and distraction rather than personal growth. Your uniqueness is what sets you apart from the rest of the world, but it requires you to build and cultivate that uniqueness, making you attractive to those who appreciate your individuality.

Forge your own path in life. This doesn't mean being reckless or acting on every impulse; rather, it means making thoughtful decisions based on solid information. Pursue what aligns with the future you envision for yourself. Your habits are crucial in shaping the life you want, so blindly imitating others can lead to regret. To make wise choices about your path, be honest with yourself and clearly understand what you want out of life.

CONFORMISM

Most people don't know why they're doing what they're doing. They imitate others, go with the flow, and follow paths without making their own.

- Derek Sivers

Conformism is the act of matching attitudes, beliefs and behaviors to group norms, politics or being like-minded. In other words, you can say it is the fact or policy of behaving or thinking like everyone else, rather than being different. It is embedded in our human nature for us to follow something, at the end of the day everyone has their own perspective of life, and you can't be the only one who has it, that idea can spread and attract other minds to follow, and there we are moving in a mob. No matter how anti-social you are or an introvert, there still exists a desire to affiliate with people who share the same philosophies as you and, in many instances, you wish the entirety of the society were somewhat like you, but it's never possible.

In our desire to fit into our community, and our neediness to be accepted and loved by people in our community we fall into a circle of endlessly chasing what people influence us to do, for instance doing what everyone else is doing on social media to be acceptable to our peers or the society. Your fear to stand for something that is of difference to people around you who you wish to win their approval will lead you to conforming to things that will lead you to living a blind life.

The world we live in today is anti-dogmatic, where everyone is developing their own principles of life that they find fit, and some of these principles get promoted into being everyone else's principles of life. It is even evident through the diverse culture of the world that we see, every country has its own culture that its people believe to be suitable.

Today's society is distracted by so many things with most of them steaming from social media, and certain attitudes, and beliefs are being pushed into people's minds without being filtered and are becoming the culture of a majority of people especially to the youth where resistance to peer pressure is becoming hard. Social media has been a means of bringing together people into groups that have great impacts on individuals that bind to them mentally, and some of these groups are productive leading to pushing individual growth and on the other hand some groups have been nothing but destructive to the lives of the individuals that bind to them.

Don't do what everyone is doing, because the chances of them being wrong are high. In many instances people are open to listening to whatever is fitting to their expectations even when it's not and that is why quite often people tend to carry beliefs that are completely wrong just to meet their expectations which turn into resentment when they're not met. Learn to accept the reality of things even when they're not what you expected, and don't compromise the truth by living a false belief to cover up for your unmet expectations.

Take control of the new ideas formed in your brain, from whatever influence they come from, then undress them to their realities and making sense of what they are, and delete them immediately when they fall out of your directive.

LOVE

Inevitably every human being's desires love, seeks it and gives it others as well, we attain it from our families, partners and friends. But in today's world the word LOVE has becoming quite a confusing word, one that has been associated with meeting emotional needs of a person and the material desires of a person. Love carries so many definitions one of them being unselfishness and willingness to give yourself for others. But how is it to be given in a world where people can literally take advantage of it and use your love for their own selfish needs.

I sometimes find it hard to use the word, because I feel using it could make a person misunderstand the intention or motive, I carry behind my expressions for something in particular. For instance, I could say I love my parents but the same word to someone else could mean- I spend time with them, I do things for them and I sacrifice myself for them. And I could literally say the same word in a sentence saying, "I love my people" but wouldn't mean I would give them the same treatment as my friends.

And the same word can also be used for the activities that we are drained into doing, and are highly motivated to do or including our jobs. To me love was always built around a narrative that involved giving something of value to other people or pouring our valuable resources like time into activities, in which we earn intimacy from people in the long run for the sexual relationships, or good relations with friends and family and of course reaping profits or fruitful products from the activities we choose to take.

But I never thought of loving myself and what could come out of it, and it could sound selfish from a certain view but at the center of everything loving yourself is what will allow you to genuinely live LOVE at its soundest form. A lot of people speak of the word, but never get to feel it, attain it or quite express it to other people. And LOVE does hurt when it doesn't get what was expected of the other party, and it can diminish over time, when friction comes in between the two parties. And people are seeking for LOVE everywhere, there are so many podcasts, channels and other content out there online that are dedicating to talking about LOVE, and I don't want to adversely have an overall say for it all.

But all I can say is demote the narrative of searching for it, rather learn to build it yourself by showing it to yourself and allowing it to flow to other people who will respond to you in an affectionate manner back to you, and there are other people who will betray you and will not respond at all and it will hurt quite often which is what most people are trying to avoid but when it comes to people don't have high expectations of them reacting full to the love you show them, ensure you love yourself first which will allow you to affiliate with those who accept you and relax when others are not interested or give a pass on you.

Human beings can be very disappointing and they will so many times, so move on when it happens. Fixating your mind on trying to fix it won't help cause people are different, people's unwillingness to respond to your love should not be a barrier to you showing it to other people. Don't stress on wanting people to love you, show it to yourself which is quite often easier said than done.

And above all, for the work that you have very strong passion for, release your love into it to the highest fidelity. The bondage you will create with it will allow you to find a means through which you feel your purpose in this world, and inevitably meet people who appreciate your work and impact other people's lives.

CHAPTER 5

DEFINING PHILOSOPHY

The sky is not the limit, your mind is.

Philosophy is a theory or attitude that acts as a guiding principle for behavior. It encompasses fundamental topics like reason, knowledge, value, mind, and language. Your perception of life and the choices you make, are based on the information in your brain and your beliefs, which are at the core of everything. For example, a very religious person might criticize the pursuit of wealth, believing it can corrupt the heart, breed greed, and conceal evil thoughts.

At the same time, a religious person might also advocate for wealth, seeing it as a means to help those in need or to make a positive impact on the community. This is something I've observed firsthand as I grew up hearing people criticize the wealthy, sometimes even associating them with the devil—an idea that seemed absurd to me as I thought more about it. What differentiates them is the beliefs they have developed around the idea of wealth.

The thing about philosophy is that two people can draw different conclusions from the same idea. Take democracy, for example. It's often portrayed as the ideal political system, promoting freedom and fairness compared to other systems. Yet, one could argue that democracy has its challenges, such as encouraging conformity simply because a decision made by a few representatives is assumed to be right for the entire society.

I grew up in a Christian home, surrounded by a community deeply rooted in the ways of Christ. Sunday church attendance was obligatory, even though I didn't always enjoy it. I sometimes pretended to be sick to avoid going, but my aunt would insist that attending church would make me feel better. I remember one day, after returning from church, my cousin Sarah asked me, "Are you hungry, Galanda?" I replied, "No, I'm full. I ate God's word." All of these thoughts were shaped by the philosophy I developed around Christianity as a child.

PARADIGMS AND PHILOSOPHY (KEY DIFFERENCES)

In the first chapter of the book, I mentioned of the term paradigm, it may sound something similar to philosophy but there are ways that we can differentiate them and later relate them together to see how they work out harmoniously in our thinking in life.

DIFFERENTIATING POINT	PHILOSOPHY	PARADIGM
Breadth	Philosophy is broader and more fundamental	Paradigms are often more specific and applied
Purpose	Philosophy seeks to understand and question	Paradigms provide frameworks for interpretation and action
Methodology	Philosophy employs logical reasoning and argumentation	Paradigms often rely on accepted practices and a field.
Temporality	Philosophical ideas tend to persist and evolve over longer periods of time	Paradigms can shift more rapidly with new discoveries or cultural changes.
Awareness	People actively engage with philosophy	People operate unconsciously operate within paradigms.

The relationship:

Philosophy and paradigms are interconnected. Philosophical ideas can influence the development of paradigms, and shifts in paradigms can prompt new philosophical inquiries. For example, the philosophical concept of empiricism influenced the development of the scientific method, which became a paradigm for conducting research.

The world you live in today is ever-evolving, different from the one your parents brought you into. You face new challenges that your parents didn't encounter when they came into this world, and you experience new things daily, largely due to the impact of modern technology. Countless ideas about life are being implanted into our minds at an overwhelming pace. Consider how people today encourage starting businesses and becoming entrepreneurs as a path to success. At the same time, others push you to follow your passions, claiming they are the key to success. On top of it all, there's the pervasive belief that "having money will make your life good."

All these conflicting ideas can be confusing, and sometimes we grow older without ever deciding what to do with our lives. It's especially challenging when, everywhere on social media, you hear advice like "Do this before you're 30," "Do that in your 20s," or "Never do this or that at any age." Some people will influence you to build a better world for yourself by keeping things to yourself, creating a darker version of yourself, and isolating yourself from society to avoid the pain of betrayal.

On the other hand, others will encourage you to be open to making mistakes, to network by making more friends, to travel more to expand your experiences, and to read books to broaden your horizons. And here I am, adding to that pile by telling you not to be a conformist in this world! It can be overwhelming and pressuring, especially when you're trying to carve out a clear path for yourself to achieve success then all over a sudden people are advising you things every time you refresh the social media feed, and let alone the things your parents are trying to advise you.

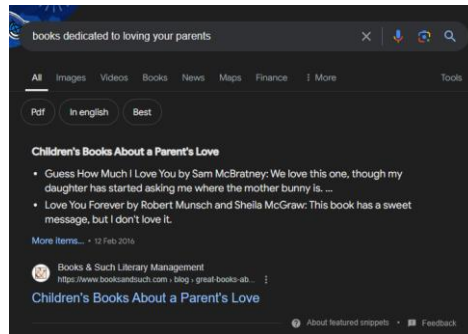
My philosophy and paradigms have changed repeatedly over the past few years, and as I write this, I'm still only 20 years old. I expect they will continue to evolve as I grow older, as there is much more to life that I have yet to experience—assuming I stay alive. However, we can prepare ourselves for the future by learning from what others have done at similar ages. Reading books can help us build better perspectives on life, especially when we encounter new challenges. This doesn't mean we won't face hardships, but we'll have a framework or idea of how to navigate these situations and steer ourselves in a better direction. Instead of reacting emotionally to the challenges we face, we'll think more about finding solutions, which is why it's crucial to read books and acquire knowledge from others in this confusing world. In case you are forgot you are still a human being, and you are living in an environment your body was not built for, and so you are running are trying to run a high-end software in your brain with an ancient body that hasn't really evolved to meet the new environment you are in.

You don't have to do as they did, but you can build your own frameworks from already working solutions to fit into your life, not every action that a person took in their lives will fit into your life path, learn from other people but do it in your own way, build your own path, that way you will be able to direct yourself in a path that brings fulfillment and happiness into your life.

In light of reading books or acquiring beneficial knowledge from people, you don't have to follow exactly in their footsteps. Instead, you can build your own frameworks based on proven solutions that fit your life. Not every action someone else took will align with your life path. Learn from others, but do it your own way. Build your own path, and that will enable you to create a life that brings fulfillment and happiness. Be open to honestly exploring truths as they reveal themselves to you learn to accept the truth even when it isn't what you want to hear. Books will teach you a lot, but real-life experiences will bring that knowledge to life.

ILYSM?

Love is one of the most discussed topics in the world, with countless opinions and perspectives. There are numerous books written to help people find love and build good relationships with their life partners in marriage. However, I have never come across a book solely dedicated to loving your parents. Curious, I decided to Google it, and here's what I found:



Yeah, you can try searching for it too—there's not much of a list there. However, if you change the search to "Books dedicated to love," you'll find a lot more, including novels and self-help books aimed at improving romantic relationships. There are tons of those out there which are quite helpful actually.

The word "love" carries strong definitions like selflessness, patience, and kindness. However, in modern times, love is often defined in a more selfish and intention-driven way with less honesty and pure emotions. There is a desire for people to love each other for material things rather than love in its purity. And it has made people make efforts to avoid the pain of being hurt by other people. And in some cases, love turns into hate after breakups or when jealousy and other ugly stuff get into the mix. And after a breakup, some individuals try to show off to their ex-partners how they are having a better life or have improved themselves.

Many of my teenage peers despised the idea, saying it made a man weak and soft. We would tell ourselves that love distracted a man and that many men fell from being in love with women who led to their downfall. With that mindset, we rolled with a narrative of pure independence and dominance over our own lives. Yet, at the end of the day, most of these peers of mine still ended up searching for partners. I guess it was just the egoistic and narcissistic version of ourselves at full display. Love is essential for humanity, be it in intimate or platonic forms; you still need it a part of your life, and you will feel the demand for it.

One of the things that have conflicted my mind about love is how African culture contrasts with the modern pop culture narrative of love. Defining love itself has been quite a complex thing for many philosophers, poets and thinkers for centuries; others have praised it and embraced it and others have despised it and have urged people to focus on themselves rather than chasing love as if it doesn't exist.

Love is a profound and multifaceted emotional and psychological state characterized by deep affection, care and connection towards another person, entity or idea. It encompasses various forms and expressions, including:

1. **Romantic Love:** Intense emotional and often physical attraction between partners, typically involving passion, intimacy, and commitment.
2. **Familial Love:** The strong bond and affection shared between family members, often characterized by unconditional care and support.
3. **Platonic Love:** A deep, non-romantic affection between friends or companions.

4. **Self-love:** The regard for one's own well-being and happiness.
5. **Altruistic Love:** Selfless concern for the well-being of others, often extending beyond personal relationships.
6. **Spiritual or Divine Love:** A sense of connection or devotion to a higher power or spiritual ideal.

These are all the forms of love that exist out there, so she might love you but in a platonic way! Or it could be Altruistic for a bargain so move on! Ok back to being serious, love is something important to be aware of because you are human, you will find it in some time in your life, it will hurt you and help you explore the many things about yourself that you never knew and it could also help you do things of merit in your community which will improve other people's lives. And love comes with a lot of key aspects like; **Emotional investments-** strong feelings of attachment, care and concern. **Commitment-** a willingness to support and stand by the loved one. **Empathy-** the ability to understand and share the feelings of another. **Sacrifice-** Willingness to prioritize the needs of the loved one over one's own. **Growth-** love often involves personal development and mutual support for growth. And there is, **Acceptance-** embracing the loved one's strengths and weaknesses.

And love tends to manifest itself in various behaviors and experiences, such as: physical and emotional intimacy, acts of kindness and support, longing for proximity and connection, a sense of security and trust and shared experiences and mutual understanding.

Reading all these aspects and manifestations of love shows just how beautiful it is isn't it? Things always sound beautiful from their definitions don't they, but unfortunately coming into their actual practicality they tend to be not as expected and sometimes far off the hook and that is why things like love are just so complicated.

I used to think of love as something that was shown to me or I had to express to someone else, but I later discovered that it started from showing it to yourself, and it is where it starts. We sometimes try to find love from friends in our community in our pursuit to find people to interact with and find the desire of being acceptable in our community and develop the sense of belonging. The world is cruel, you won't be loved by everyone and you as well won't love everyone some friction will happen between you and some people and it can even happen naturally, and could even happen at your work place and have no choice but to work with them and you should, in a kind way.

You could also experience the different forms of love with other people, what matters the most is self-love. It is the base that can allow for forming the other forms of love, learn to care for your own health and life as well, if you love yourself you should try to do anything that will cause unhappiness in your life or great regret later. And as a fact that not everybody in this world will love you, love yourself so that you are alone sufficient to carry yourself on, from there you can use that love to build things, start projects or initiate careers that will bring fulfillment and happiness into your life and by a happy life I don't mean you won't be sad, you'll lose people, feel depressed and many other draining emotional states, but they are temporary moods and will wary away if you still maintain a happy life.

Of the forms one that I have exclusively experienced in my life is familial love, my parents, sister and relatives have been a big part of my life, always being there for me and stepping up into my life whenever I needed their help, at times I took it for granted but later in life I realized the big sacrifices they made for me in my life and always being happy for me whenever I made small achievements in life. If you are blessed to experience this kind of love, keep close to it and cherish it, it will bring a lot of joy in your life and propel you to accomplish big things in life, because people will discourage you but you will always find your way back to yourself because of their love.

And don't be selfish to show it to people who deserve it, other people will take advantage of it, when it happens walk away, take out all the toxic people in your life who just suck your energy for their own selfish motives.

CONFLICT LOVE

It's worth noticing that love has a subjective nature, it can be experienced and interpreted differently by each individual. In fact, it's experience and expression can vary significantly across cultures, individuals and contexts. It is also dynamic, often evolving over time and through different life stages. One of the things that ever confused me growing up was just how love was expressed different in my native country compared to what I saw on Hollywood movies, portrayed under the modern pop culture. I'd like to compare the love paradigm that I grew up around on this topic in comparison to the pop culture.

PARADIGM\CULTURE	AFRICAN CULTURE	POPULAR CULTURE
View of Love	Often sees love as intertwined with respect, family honor and community values.	Often portrays love as passionate, individualistic and sometimes transient.
Approach to Relationships	Emphasizes waiting until marriage for sexual intimacy.	More accepting to premarital sexual relationships and casual dating.
Mate Selection	Often involves family input and consideration of social/ cultural compatibility.	Emphasizes personal choice, attraction and individual compatibility.
Family Formation	Prioritizes stable, long-term commitments and often larger, extended family structures.	More diverse family structures, including non-traditional arrangements.

Pop culture has been made famous through globalization, which has become more of a standard for defining the way love should be for most people who have been exposed to it. I grew around a family that highly prioritized over the African(native) culture and so even seeing all this pop culture stuff online caused me cognitive dissonance as it disturbed the beliefs I had carried in my life. The pop culture paradigm over love has caused effects such as the following:

1. **Changing Expectations:** The pop culture paradigm has introduced ideas of romantic love and personal fulfillment that sometimes clash with traditional African values of family stability and community harmony.
2. **Delayed Marriage:** Exposure to pop culture ideas has contributed to some young Africans delaying marriage to pursue education, careers, or explore relationships.
3. **Generational Conflict:** Many young Africans find themselves navigating between traditional family expectations and more individualistic pop culture ideals, leading to potential family tensions.
4. **Redefinition of Commitment:** The pop culture paradigm's acceptance of casual relationships has challenged traditional notions of commitment, sometimes leading to uncertainty in relationship progression.
5. **Expanded Mate Pool:** Global connectivity and pop culture influence have expanded the potential mate pool beyond local communities, sometimes challenging traditional matchmaking practices.

6. **Shifting Family Structures:** While extended family structures remain important in many African contexts, there's a growing acceptance of nuclear families and single parenthood, influenced partly by pop culture representations.
7. **Value Conflicts:** The emphasis on sexual purity in many African cultures can conflict with pop culture's more liberal attitudes, creating personal and social dilemmas for young people.
8. **Evolving Rituals:** Traditional courtship and marriage rituals are being adapted or sometimes bypassed, influenced by pop culture portrayals of romance and weddings.

This interplay between traditional African paradigms and pop culture influences has created a complex landscape for love, relationships, and family formation. Many individuals find themselves balancing respect for cultural heritage with desires for personal fulfillment and modern lifestyles. This tension is reshaping the philosophy of many African contexts, leading to evolving perspectives on relationships, marriage and family that blend traditional values with contemporary ideas.

Exposure to any culture that steps over the so viewed as limitations without properly understanding what is being promoted leads people into shifting their paradigms from adopting new philosophies which drive the society into new ways of life and eventually changing the society in irreversible ways and this is why some new practices in Africa will be so hard to eliminate.

I personally have also questioned myself several times on what I should do, in this very confusing world where love has taken a very big shift and change in perspective, and so I mostly tried to read books and speak to my parents which even made it more confusing for me to decide on what to do. And it could be the same for many of the youths out there living in Africa, and the harder point of all this comes at a time where sexual drive in people is becoming more with pleasure for sex being promoted to the highest extent and now being portrayed as more of an activity done to satisfy bodily pleasure rather than satisfying the actual reproductive role of sex which is for procreation and ensuring human survival by increasing the population.

And everyone has built their own way of living around this, and it's up to you to build your own as well, I researched on how different people approached it, and their counsel on the entire idea of it. And weighed which facts aligned with my own values and perceptions and frankly that I had peace with, and you should do the same as well. You will listen to countless advisories on love, what it is, whom to give it to, how to find it and others will tell you to keep it to yourself. But you can't do everything that people say cause that will lead you to not achieving anything out of it, as for me, I find it more sensible to form long-term relationships aimed at improving each other and eventually leading up to marriage. It may not sound sensible to you because we're different, confusion in this world can only be avoided by making choices on what you stand for. Not making choices and listening to every whim out there will depower you of having clarity.

CULTURAL COMPLEXITY AND EVOLUTION

During my final year of high school, our school hosted a debate comparing western and African cultures. While I don't recall which side won, I remember a private discussion with my classmate, Venance, that left a lasting impression on me. Initially, I argued that African culture was "weak" for failing to maintain its originality, leading to what I perceived as immoral behaviors in our society.

Venance, however, presented a more nuanced view. He argued that culture is inherently complex and evolves over time, adapting practices from other cultures to form new traditions. His perspective suggested that African cultures had undergone transformations, incorporated new elements while retained their core identities.

Challenging his viewpoint, I questioned why many Asian cultures seemed to preserve more of their original aspects despite globalization's influence. We concluded that cultures differ in their resilience to change, with some more adaptable than others. This discussion reminded me of a quote

from Steven Bartlett's "The Diary of a CEO": "If the culture is strong, new people will become like the culture. If the culture is weak, the culture will become like the new people." While Bartlett applied this concept to startup culture, it equally resonates with societal cultures, shaping how people communicate and interact within communities.

It's important to note that culture varies across demographics, from families to regions to nations. For this discussion, I'll focus on national cultures as a baseline. Culture shapes the dynamics of community interaction; deviating from societal norms often leads to being perceived as an outsider.

The introduction of new elements into a culture often creates initial confusion and resistance. Some new practices are rejected, while others are grudgingly accepted but criticized. Over time, some initially controversial elements become permanent aspects of the culture, sometimes creating intergenerational tensions. Many elderly people express disappointment in how younger generations have adopted new cultural styles that seem unacceptable or foreign to them.

Personally, I believe it's unsustainable for a culture to remain rigid in the face of technological change. As our environments evolve, so too must aspects of our culture to remain relevant. However, it's crucial to recognize that fundamental human nature - our emotions and basic needs - remains constant, even as our cultural expressions change.

As we enter the age of artificial intelligence (AI), we should prepare for potentially significant cultural shifts. These changes may challenge our existing philosophies and create feelings of cognitive dissonance. Some may question the value of traditional career paths, while others might seek emotional companionship from AI. Despite these shifts, certain fundamental human realities will persist. For instance, the need for human touch and connection will remain crucial, as it's an intrinsic part of our nature that cannot be fully replicated by AI.

Today, we live in an increasingly pluralistic world where individual choices are often considered valid as long as they don't violate established laws. While this openness can be positive, it's important to remember that popularity doesn't equate to truth or ethical correctness. Facts remain true regardless of popular opinion.

When people of the same culture work together, they often thrive due to shared visions and values. However, it's impossible to develop a perfect lifestyle or avoid all mistakes. The key is to craft a way of life that aligns with your values while remaining open to growth and change.

Modern society has moved away from many traditional, society-wide cultural norms. People now have more freedom to incorporate their own traditions or ideas into their personal cultures. For example, dress codes have become more flexible in many societies, allowing for greater individual expression which is positive and there are many other ideas embedded into people's personal cultures which are shared amongst some groups as well.

The lifestyle and culture you choose will naturally attract you to people who share similar values. While you may differ in some aspects, the core values you share will be crucial in forming connections. It's important to develop a healthy culture that allows for positive interactions with others, strong relationships, and personal growth.

Culture is not static but a dynamic, evolving entity shaped by historical forces, technological advancements, and human interactions. Understanding this complexity can help us navigate cultural changes more effectively, appreciating both the value of tradition and the necessity of adaptation in our rapidly changing world.

CHAPTER 6

REALITY AND REALISM

“We find only the world we look for” - Henry D. Thoreau

Reality refers to the state of things as they actually exist, independent of human perception or interpretation. It's objective and exists regardless of whether we observe or understand it. However, our human limitations often make it difficult to comprehend fully.

Does reality change? Reality can indeed evolve, governed by natural laws and causality. Certain forces, actions, or events can influence new realities in our lives. There are achievements in life that remain unattainable unless we acquire the capacity to make them happen. Faith is built around reality—it's the belief in things yet to occur, often centered on outcomes that seem unrealistic. It's what makes people to this day believe they can migrate to a higher status than the ones they have now.

Realism, on the other hand, is an approach or attitude that attempts to represent or describe things as they actually are, without idealization or romanticization. It's a human construct, a way of perceiving and representing reality. While realism aims to capture reality as accurately as possible, it remains subject to human interpretation. It can evolve as our understanding of reality changes or as philosophical movements shift.

We live in a world where many people ignore reality, while others remain ignorant of life's realities. There's still much to discover about life, as it's a long journey. Some realities only become apparent through experience—when we actually live life and come to understand its nuances.

Though these terms sound similar, they differ significantly in their objectivity. Reality is objective and exists independently; it is what actually exists—the truth. Realism, however, is a subjective attempt to capture or represent that reality. It's more relative to human constructs.

Realism is how human beings live in pursuit of reality. It chases reality, and the more realistic we are, the closer we come to clarity and living in reality. However, it's challenging for realism to achieve a perfect representation of reality. While reality is the absolute truth of existence, realism is our human endeavor to understand and live according to that truth. The pursuit of realism can lead us closer to understanding reality, but it's important to remember that our perceptions and interpretations will always be influenced by our human limitations and perspectives.

SEEING THINGS AS THEY ARE



*“We don’t see things as they are, we see them as we are.”
-Anais Nin.*

Quite often I argue with people on how they should perceive or live their life, but I later stopped because I found it pointless and most of the arguments would end with me saying; “you do what you find right, and I will do what I find right.” The lens through which we observe or view life comes as a result of the different life experiences we have lived through, as to you as well you have met a lot of people who didn’t have the same views as you, because both of you grew up in different backgrounds.

But isn’t reality clear, isn’t it one and doesn’t it carry one truth? It does, no matter where you come from in life, no matter how your views are different from each other, there are fundamentals that

will always remain true to shaping the reality by which you should focus on to make life less confusing. You need to **UNDERSTAND OBJECTIVE REALITY**. To see things as they actually are you have to be free from distortions of personal biases or wishful thinking, if one of the dogs on the picture would've gone to the other side, they would've agreed on the same thing.

Seeing things as they are is crucial in life when it comes to decision-making like when making a choice on which career to go after. The problem that makes people not want to hear the truth is because they find it pessimistic or cynical, and they forget to see the clarity behind things. It would be better to have an honest self-reflection and have an objective assessment of your circumstances.

Remember the incident I shared with you earlier about my career goals, when my mom told me to study computers instead of going for aerospace engineering like I wanted earlier. She saw things as they were and came to draw up the circumstances that we were in, of course a scholarship could be possible, but would it even be worth the shot? Sometimes you just have to accept some trade-offs when making life decisions, it is hard to make a perfect decision, each decision you make will come with its downfalls that you will have to live with, and embrace the more important things.

Take a considerate view of Galanda, yes me now focus! So Galanda wanted to launch a startup with his friend James with their first app being an e-commerce app called Shopping Spree at least this was the first name that came into his mind, one afternoon as he was headed to get lunch at the school dining hall, he ran to James and pitched the idea of a platform that could revolutionize shopping forever in Tanzania and make it easier for people to shop or sell things through the platform.

James also saw how the app could actually make a change in the commercial sector of Tanzania, and they pitched it at the **WIBONELE** science competitions which were locally hosted by the school, and they also used it as an entry into the Young Scientists of Tanzania competition but didn't make it through. And their team came fourth in the **WIBONELE** competitions, then James told Galanda, "I told you they would never get it".

So Galanda was so hyped about his idea and kept pitching it to other people, because he imagined that it would be the greatest thing to happen in Tanzania, and as a matter of fact having been obsessed with all the sole founders of successful startups in the world, he believed he could become one himself.

After graduating high school, during the break they finally made research on their project, and James made a final conclusion on how he found the startup would turn out in the end through an email to Galanda;

let us be realistic ! Inbox x



James Temanya

<jamestemanya3@gmail.com>

to me ▾

Sun, Jun 23, 5:18 PM ☆ 😊 ↶ ⋮

Dear Galanda,

I hope this email finds you well. I've recently conducted extensive research into our plan to launch a shopping app in Tanzania, and I've uncovered some crucial insights that I believe warrant an urgent discussion. After consulting with an AI assistant for a realistic perspective, I've come to the conclusion that we need to seriously reconsider our approach. Please allow me to break down the key points with relevant scenarios:

- Technical Challenges:**

Scenario: Imagine we launch our app, and during our first flash sale, we get 10,000 simultaneous users. Our servers crash, orders are lost, and we're flooded with customer complaints. We realize we lack the expertise to scale our infrastructure properly, and we lose credibility overnight.

Reality Check: We need years of experience or a highly skilled technical team to handle this level of complexity.
- Market Misunderstanding:**

Scenario: We design our app with a sleek, minimalist interface that we think looks great. After three months, we have only 500 downloads, while a local competitor with a more colorful, information-rich design has 50,000. User feedback reveals that Tanzanians find our app "foreign" and "hard to understand."

Reality Check: Understanding local preferences requires deep market research and experience we currently lack.
- Financial Constraints:**

Scenario: We underestimate customer acquisition costs. We spend our entire allocated budget on Facebook ads, acquiring 2,000 users. However, we need 20,000 to break even. With no more marketing budget, growth stagnates, and the business becomes unsustainable within months.

Reality Check: We need a much larger financial runway and a better understanding of unit economics.
- Regulatory Compliance:**

Scenario: Six months after launch, we're hit with a certain fine like (4million Tzsh) fine for improperly handling user data. The Tanzania Communications Regulatory Authority orders us to cease operations until we implement proper security measures, which we can't afford.

Reality Check: Understanding and complying with local regulations requires legal expertise we don't currently possess.

5. Infrastructure Challenges:

Scenario: We receive numerous complaints from users in rural areas who can't complete purchases due to poor internet connectivity. Our app, which requires constant connection, is unusable for a large portion of our target market.

Reality Check: We need to design for local infrastructure limitations, which requires in-depth knowledge of the country's tech landscape.

Given these scenarios and others I've analyzed, the AI assistant estimated our chances of success at less than 1%. This is primarily due to our lack of experience, limited resources, and the complexity of the e-commerce market in Tanzania.

Proposed Action Plan(still in progress):

1. Education:lets Consider enrolling university programs or intensive coding bootcamps.
2. Experience: lets Seek internships or entry-level positions at established e-commerce companies in Tanzania.
3. Network: Attending local tech meetups, entrepreneurship events, and business seminars to build connections.
4. Start Smaller: Creating a simpler app that solves a specific problem in our community as a learning experience.
5. Long-term Planning: Developing a 5-10 year plan to systematically acquire the skills, experience, network, and resources we'll need.

I understand this isn't aligned with our initial vision, but I strongly believe that adopting a more measured approach will significantly increase our chances of long-term success.

Looking forward to your thoughts on this matter.

Best regards,
James Joseph Temanya

Ok, let me be realistic as well. When James sent me this email, he texted me on WhatsApp to go and read it, I was honestly happy that now we could have something to work on and start of first steps to reaching the success we had been dreaming for since High School and I thought to myself that this was it!

I read the email about four times, surprisingly I even laughed and texted him back that the email was cool, well drafted and very typical of him. We somehow found humor in dark comments so this was kind of funny at some point to us, and he was not wrong, the scale of the idea that we had, was just unrealistic to work in the environment we were in and we had our hopes up for nothing.

Especially considering the fact that we didn't have sufficient knowledge on how to even build the product, but as you can see at the end, he came up with a solution on what we could do to make it happen. And this goes for all the things you want to get in life, but there seems no way, getting your hopes up that they will appear from thin air will not or least I can say will never happen.

Imagination without taking actions will get your dreams to no place other than the graveyard. There is always a way to get things done, but you will get there when you accept to find the clarity in the situation and live by the reality of things.

But seeing things as they are also involves recognizing our own patterns and behaviors, we sometimes jump from idea to idea the minute we find it hard and don't find any success in it. We sometimes just literally want things the easy way and that pushes us to terminating every project we start the minute we find it hard to accomplish or achieve, and of course there are poor decisions that we make from anger.

I had anger issue growing up which led me to fighting with a lot of my friends, I was very reactive when people said or did something to me that I found offensive which made me fall into trouble for fighting with other people. It did come to me again when I mostly conversated with James, in my ego to fit into the conversation, I commented on things that I had no know abouts or enough information to provide. And James suggested that I made sure I knew what I was talking about before I spoke with concrete references and facts.

And me realizing this, made me accept my downfalls that I was egoistic, narcissistic at times, and I was open to reading books to lessen my ignorance and fix my reactions to my emotions. And we can only experience significant change in our lives when we accept our downfalls and begin to slowly fix the wrong mentalities that we had about life, and rebuild our brain models to fit in reality.

Be honest with your downfalls! Seeing things as they **ACTUALLY** are will help you make better decisions, and mistakes are inevitable you'll still make them either way, but you can make less mistakes with bearable consequences.

EMBRACING YOUR REALITY

Embracing your personal reality means accepting your strengths, weaknesses, circumstances, and the consequences of your choices. This acceptance isn't about resignation but about creating a solid platform for growth and change. In today's world, we often face overwhelming pressures from society, family, and friends regarding various aspects of our lives, pushing us to make certain decisions and choices.

While it's often well-intentioned when parents or close friends want what's best for us, these influences can sometimes lead to decisions that make us unhappy or uncertain. For instance, after completing high school with good results, I faced pressure to attend specific universities or pursue "marketable" courses like Civil Engineering. However, these suggestions didn't align with my long-term vision for my life.

Many of us encounter moments where we're presented with multiple choices, all seemingly logical, which can be confusing. Social media exacerbates this by presenting curated, idealized versions of reality, leading to feelings of inadequacy when compared to carefully crafted online personas. These platforms often promote simplistic ideas, such as money being the sole determinant of happiness, or offer a plethora of conflicting advice on dating and finances.

Overcoming these social pressures requires self-awareness, resilience, and commitment. It's crucial not to make choices that will later lead to unhappiness or to change who you are merely to please others temporarily. Communication is key in these situations. Sharing your thoughts with parents or loved ones can help align them with your vision and potentially gain their support. Even if they initially seem to have fixed viewpoints, explaining your perspective can increase your confidence in pursuing your chosen path.

Changing established narratives can be challenging, and there may be fears of isolation. However, living a life dictated by others' expectations is ultimately unfulfilling. This doesn't mean rejecting all family values; good communication and maintaining family relationships are still important. But when it comes to crucial decisions like career choices, following your own intuition – based on self-awareness and careful consideration – is often the best path forward.

In part of embracing your reality you should also learn to live by what you have, living in the present not in some imagination that can turn into resentment once these highly anticipated expectations are not met. I remember how earlier I gave you the example with the idea I had going with James, had he not hinted to me the reality of what we were facing I would be chasing for something that wouldn't be possible.

We as human beings have limitations to achieving certain things, we all have them, making it hard for us to achieve certain things and life. Some goals that we set out in life require little effort to achieve, some require a little more effort and others are completely unattainable no matter what we will do in our life. Realization of these things can help us to focus on our capabilities in life and pushing them to their highest levels to attain the greater things in life.

An essential aspect of embracing your reality is learning to live with what you have, focusing on the present rather than dwelling in imaginary scenarios that can lead to resentment or least depression when high expectations aren't met. For example, had a friend not pointed out the reality of a situation to me, I might have pursued an unattainable goal, leading to disappointment and frustration.

As human beings, we all have limitations that can make it difficult to achieve certain things in life. Some goals require little effort, others demand significant work, and some are simply unattainable regardless of our efforts. Recognizing these realities can help us focus on our actual capabilities, pushing them to their highest levels to attain greater things in life. This realistic approach allows us to set achievable goals and appreciate our progress, rather than constantly chasing unattainable ideals. So you can't be like Ronaldo, Messi, Elon Musk or me, hahaa. But you can be the best version of yourself, embrace your life to being a person who you'd personally be proud of.

CHANGING REALITY

As human beings, we constantly strive to make changes in our lives, often attempting to align our current reality with the one we've imagined. We rarely seek to change aspects of our lives that we find comfortable or satisfactory. Instead, we focus on changing elements that we perceive as threats or sources of dissatisfaction.

The ability to change our reality exists on different levels. At the societal level, this responsibility has traditionally fallen to the government. However, this role is increasingly being taken up by individuals who have the initiative to address issues at whatever scale they can manage. For instance, numerous people are working hard to address poverty out of genuine concern for others.

While there are various landscapes where change can occur, such as our work environments, I'd like to focus on the personal level. Changing the reality of our own lives is often less complicated than effecting change at broader levels, though it still comes with its own challenges and complexities. The crucial factor here is that we have a degree of control over our own lives. To a certain extent, we can make decisions that improve our circumstances and help us progress towards our goals.

By reframing challenges as opportunities and focusing on what we can control, we can begin to shape our circumstances. For example, someone facing unemployment might view it as an opportunity to pursue a long-held dream of starting a business. This perspective can also help us realize whether our current pursuits align with our long-term goals. For instance, you may be passionate about a certain hobby, but building a sustainable life around it could be challenging. Recognizing this reality and pursuing the hobby while choosing a more marketable career path could be important for building a sustainable life.

It's important to understand that while seeing and accepting reality as it is, is crucial, this doesn't mean we're powerless to change it. In fact, a realistic understanding of the world is often the first step towards meaningful transformation.

PART THREE

EQUILIBRIUM IN THE CHAOS

“A mind that is unfocused is vulnerable to “the world, the flesh,
and the devil,” all of which exert a downward pull on your thoughts.
As your thinking processes deteriorate, you become
increasingly confused and directionless.”

— Sarah Young

CHAPTER 7

DEATH

"No one wants to die. Even people who want to go to heaven don't want to die to get there. And yet death is the destination we all share. No one has ever escaped it. And that is as it should be, because Death is very likely the single best invention of Life. It is Life's change agent." - Steve Jobs

Life is like a game, thinking you have heard this so many times before I have even mentioned it here, if you haven't there it is. In any game there is a reward that you expect of course, and if you lose, we call it game over. And not only is it a game, but one filled with so many puzzles, that rattle our minds over and over, from time to time.

I have had conversations of death with my parents from time to time, my mom would always ask me to change the subject as it was uncomfortable for her to speak of it. But my dad, being a pastor and conducted many funeral services, he told me: death is inevitable, no one can escape it, and quite often it happens when we least expected it. However, he would tell me that no matter what happens after death, you have to remember to continue with your life, and keep progressing, events like these shape new chapters in our lives, it changes some people from the grief, others lose hope and other people make decisions to avoid or embrace the changes in life.

And change has been something that has been hard for most of us to live by and accept, especially when we are not willing to accept the situation and the future to come without the expectations that we had. But it is important to acknowledge death and understand what it means for our lives, it carries big significance and it is something that we cannot avoid.

IT'S ALL ABOUT THE ENDGAME

It is of no doubt that everything has an end, there is no game that has no finishing or end. And the same goes for life, at some point our relationships, careers and eventually breathe comes to an end we are mortal. But that doesn't make our life pointless, because time is one of the greatest asset men can have. The way we choose to spend this asset to bring the income of happiness of joy or loss of sadness is up to us.

In school, what matters the most is the final exam it describes your efforts throughout the entire academic run in the particular timeframe. And this was what I learnt from my classmates, instead of frustrating over the bad grades that I scored in between the school terms I should've been focusing more on preparing for the final exam which helped me prepare myself for the bigger examinations that were to come.

The challenging thing about results, is that they define success or failure only no matter how hard you worked, number of occasions you were right or the small wins you made along the way. Like in sports a team could play very well throughout the entire season, but if it didn't win the league that's it, I honestly felt for Arsenal when they twice lost the league to Manchester City, after leading the league over long point gaps, and just to come to lose it at the final games for two seasons in a row!

Retirement is one of the things, that marks the endgame for people's career where if you haven't saved enough cash to support your life later, or limited with supporting resources or sources of income like from children life could become so challenging. And sometimes in our youth we are encouraged to live to the fullest as we won't get that energy or time again, when we become old, and some people spend their youth doing reckless things in the name of enjoying their youth while they can.

And of course you won't have anything in life for permanents, but as we live in the moment it's good to make good use of what we have, not taking anything for granted, living with gratitude and making most of the time we have. Warren Buffet inspires me on how he's managing to stay in Berkshire Hathaway despite how old he has become; he could sit back and just enjoy his wealth.

My grandfather from my mother's side was a pastor, he's currently about 87 years approaching 88. We lived with him at home more when he was about 80 years, there were times where he would feel sick and the doctors wouldn't find anything wrong with his body from the diagnostics relating to his description of how he felt sick. So, they proposed to prepare a family gathering to celebrate his 80th birthday, which actually helped him cheer up and turns out he was just lonely.

He moved to Dodoma from Mwanza where he lived with my uncle to come and live with our family, his routine was almost basic- he woke up early, brushed his teeth, came out of breakfast and would read the bible, pray or go for a walk along the day. Sometimes he would do some manual work on his own to keep himself active. My grandfather was a farmer and a pastor but mainly focused on his ministries and later retired.

Whenever I talked to him, he was happy to share how enjoyed doing the work he did which gave him joy at his old age, he didn't mention of any life regrets that he had, and one of the things that made him proud was how his children had managed to build good lives for themselves to be able to support his needs and carry his medical care costs. Before I went to school, he would always ask me to say good bye first and would put his hands on my head and pray for me before I went, and I really enjoyed his presence.

Dying with an impact in other people's lives, from our families to even the younger generations can create great fulfillment to us. Though it is undeniable that eventually you will be forgotten once you pass away, and you can die at any age whether old or young, but what matters the most is how you spend even the minimalist time you can get. It's never late, too young and you can never be too old to do something of good value to your own community.

LIVING IN CONSCIOUSNESS TO DEATH

During a conversation with my dad, on death- we discussed how death could make people be more aware of the choices they choose to make in this world, and how they live generally. I think you understand me when you hear someone say, "spend the most time with your loved ones, you never know when they'll go away" or you could hear, "in this world we shall all come to die, so spend the rest of your days doing things that matter most to you". And there are many other scenarios where death is included in the conversation and it brings us to our humbleness where we remember of the limited time we have.

But yeah, few hours later we would forget and not be conscious of it anymore. It's like we live every day of our life, forgetting that it would come to an end sometimes, and we remember it only when the idea pops in our heads. I'm not saying you shouldn't enjoy life or constantly live worrying about death. Rather I am insisting on living life by realization that it would come to an end, and making meaningful choices from that realization.

It happens in life to that we also lose the people who are closest to us, and it brings us pain and to some it diminishes the hope of living the life of our expectations. I am thankful to still have my parents around to this day, several times I have had conversations with many people who have lost their parents, some of them were orphans and some of them were left to live with one parent.

Death incidences affect people differently depending on their ages, and their abilities to cope with different situations as they occur. And most schools that I went to, they'd never tell the students directly of the death of their parents, rather they would inform them that there was a minor problem at home and they were needed and most of the time they would decode the message to understand that somebody in their family had died.

A friend of mine, back in high school lost his father upon coming back to school, I simply asked if he was okay. And he had a more pumped-up energy than before and he told me he was ok and it was like three days after the burial ceremony. He told me that even while he headed home, he was okay with the situation, and he told me that accepting reality comes with pain, but pain builds you. And so, in the conversation, he said that the death of his father does have effects with the support he needs for university later on, but it doesn't mean that he can't find a way, and he said his main focus was on building his life from where he stood.

There would be also other friends too, who lost their parents and would constantly ask very tough questions that I had no way of responding to, and most of the time it would be on: why it happened sooner, or why didn't I know if he or she was sick and many other thoughts that lived around. And sometimes it came at the regret of maybe they didn't feel they had lived enough with their parents which brought in regret and sadness to their lives.

In 2023 my father lost his mother, whom had begun to recover so well from her illness, but she accidentally slipped on the staircase to walk into the house which led to her death. I felt pity for my dad who had spent a lot of his time taking care of her, only coming to a good recovery had she lost her life. Upon her death, I came to realize how maybe I didn't spend enough time with her, or responded enough to her care. She literally called every year even when I forgot to, and would pray for me on the phone and wish me well in my studies, and always kept track of how I was doing in class.

But in processing it, I accepted that I couldn't repay her for what she had done in my life, but I could embrace that energy into something else of impact to other people. In the book *Master Your Emotions* by *Thibaut Meurisse* he describes emotions as energy, death as tail events happen and you can't predict them, and being sad over them over long periods of time is not healthy. Feel the down energy, feel the sadness process it and transform that energy into compassion for other people who would like to get your support or energy and abilities to help them, similar to how you could help the loved ones. That way I decided I would transform the sadness of losing my grandma to treating my parents better, having more time with them, helping them out, and giving them what I can from my abilities. Though death brings great impacts into lives, it doesn't prevent us from living out the rest of our lives.

CHAPTER 8

THE WORLD BEYOND

“You can’t go back and change the beginning, but you can start where you are and change the ending.” - C.S. Lewis

Only you have the power to shape the **WORLD** you live in, your view of life that you have so far are a deep construction of all the experiences of life you have had, and through that construction is how you will see other people too, people who seemed to be unfocused on your lens will seem way out of how they are supposed to live life.

The realism you create for yourself is not universal, there are about 8 billion people, and everyone in their own way has created their own perceptions of this world. And sometimes it’s confusing for some of us to know where to stand, and choose what is right, because in our own selves lies the need to fit into the society by having people who share the same things as us and thus, we follow other people so that we are not left alone like the peer pressure we have to do whatever our friends ask us to do, but there are people who do break out of this.

Society in many times or even the communities we have lived in has casted out people who were different from its norms and traditions calling them outcasts, and our brains are tuned to find a way to constantly survive in this world, and it’s using the same old survival thinking it had in the past, when we were chased by predators and using it in the new world where it just seems irrelevant. Having a few likes, or few status views doesn’t affect you or doesn’t say you are not loved, and yet people sometimes irrationally take it into account and feel as if they are being disregarded by the society.

In our way to avoid social outcast, we try to live up to the status quo in a world where so many cultural shifts and lifestyle shifts have taken place ever since liberalism became the new social highlight.

CHOICES

Ever heard of the phrase; “Choice is the best gift given to human”? If not-cool. Unlike animals we carry more autonomy on what we can do with our own lives. But some of our choices are limited by the existing laws, or authorities that are existent and going against them, could cost you to lose the ability to make any further choices in your life. The range of choices you are allowed to make are made possible by the extent to which you are given or guaranteed of freedom.

As a person who is in charge of your own life, be wary of the choices you make because ultimately you are the one who will carry the consequences of all of your actions. Some of the choices we make are influenced by parents or our peers and sometimes we even try to influence other to act in accordance with what we find is right from our own perspectives, but in your life most of the times, you will be the one to call the shots on what is to be done, don’t depend on other people to influence your decisions because you are the one who will carry the consequences and not anybody else.

Very likely, we should also let other people be free to make their own choices, instead of imposing them to go for ours, it’s better to help them understand what they really want and help them make their own decision from there. During university applications, after the selections came out some people tried to inquire me on which university they should go to out of the multiple selections they had got, so I tried to ask them a few questions to understand what career they wanted, or whether the environment in which they studied in mattered more to them.

By asking these questions and helping them layout the framework a bit better helped them make decisions, sometimes people fail to make decisions because of conflicting interests, but in every choice that you will make in this life will come with trade-offs from selecting your career or job to even choosing where to live. There is no single life choice in your life that will be able to satisfy all of your needs, and some of these choices will come with great sacrifices.

THE MARKET

If you take a preview at human's history, we notice that a **MARKET** enabled us to meet our needs at times when our environment couldn't produce these needs. But the former barter trade failed due to lack of the coincidence of wants, where it was hard to find someone offering what they want for what you have.

And this problem including others led to the development of money or currency which since then has evolved in different forms as we are headed to a potential cryptocurrency system. So, this market as well evolved creating needs for other things as well as we now have job markets, where people get hired based on their skills to meet the demands of their employers and get money in return to meet their financial needs or demands.

People will always have needs that need to be satisfied through the existing markets, and whoever manages to solve their problems or meet their needs with the highest convenience will be rewarded by making an earning. With the age of **AI** that comes ahead of us, there grows strong fear many jobs being replaced by more capable robots or computer systems that perform better and more efficiently than human beings in certain tasks.

In many conversations with my friends, we ask ourselves of how the **AI** age will affect the job market, and considering the current level of unemployment great fear lied in whether there would be jobs to occupy. The future is built on things that are yet to come. To our best of abilities, we try to make predictions of what could happen in the future and quite often we are wrong on what happens because there are so many factors that affect the future, with our own choices at the very root of it and we can't determine what action one will take and the consequences that will come with it all at once.

However, in strong belief, I hold the idea that people's needs will never come to diminish, in fact there are many problems that arise every day in human's lives. Making an income will still be possible in the future with **AI**, but to those who will be able to deliver at the required quality and standards with short amount of time.

The fast-developing technology has made people demand satisfaction of their needs at a higher pace while maintaining the reach for their standards of quality which is becoming difficult for some industries to keep up with the customers, and this is where **AI** fits into the timeframe. The robustness and rapidness that it promises is highly seductive for people to ignore that every company want to utilize into their services and products to highly reach the demands of their customers.

There are many comments made by different people trying to predict what the future of **AI** will bring and what people should do to prepare that it is becoming confusing for so many of us. However, whatever these computers won't be able to do that is marketable will be of high value. And there is still an optimism in me that people who will be able to leverage this technology and build solid businesses or careers around it will still be able to fit into the market.

COMPETITION

You are not the only one who want to get that job, position or resource that exists in the world. Someone else is either preventing you from getting it and there are other people challenging you to get it. Competition is natural it's there and it exists, when you win someone else loses, which is a natural thing because we are all human beings and we are striving to survive, and the fittest of all get to survive and make it.

Unlike the past where we scrambled for food, and land to get favorable living conditions, we are today competing for fame, money, land, love and many other resources of beneficiary to us. It's the old brain system again, acting out from ancient experience in the present, we feel depressed when other people make it before us or envy them, and it gives us a sense of threat that we are either not doing enough or not moving at all in life.

But those are your emotions and it's not your problem, they sometimes come into you even when all you have is good intentions for a person, we are all human beings. But you shouldn't act on them by trying to go down the rail to compete against other people and try to compete for the emotion

of being superior than the other, it won't help. So pray for people who do better than you even if you don't feel like it, don't be a life-sucking grinch!

There are times where you should let your emotions flow to allow intimate interaction with other people, but not here... it's not wise to let your emotions get the best of you, acting on your emotions will make you make horrible decisions that will make you regret even more later and it will hinder you from seeing better outcomes and practices that you can follow to pull out of the day.

There are so many things on social media that will trigger you, enforcing you to chase of after short term gratification so as to acquire the status signal of success or anything else, and social media helps people to share the life moments or express themselves to their large network of friends who they can't access closely due to geographical distancing as others share with pride and others share with great humility. Relying on your ancient brain interpretations will not help you at all, switch to your thinking and cognitive abilities to redraw better conclusions in such situations and take better action.

The thing about emotions or thoughts is that they derail in things that are not of existence and are not tangible, refocusing your energy to build yourself instead and focus on your own abilities and situation to get to where you really want to get to will be saner. It's clear that we have different opportunities presented to us, different abilities, characters, personalities and mindsets that make us different from each other hence making everything we do in one way or another different to other people who could have similar or a same position.

Our society has grown so robust, technology is moving so rapidly and in the globalization scape of the new world, competition is at it's peak, every company is competing to be the best company and reach revenue goals. This attracts for highly skilled people and promoting meritocracy, where a person is hired by their ability, and value can be provided to people through goods produced, or the various forms of services that people need, which in return they will pay you for the value you have given to them.

CAREER

A career is a person's lifelong journey of work and professional development. It encompasses a series of jobs, positions, or roles that contribute to a person's professional growth, identity, and fulfillment. Unlike a job, which is often a temporary or specific position, a career is a broader concept that reflects a person's long-term aspirations, goals, and contributions to their field or industry.

A career could embark on different types of works such as,

- **Paid employment:** Full-time, part-time or contract jobs.
- **Self-employment-** Starting and running one's own business.
- **Volunteer work-** Contributing to non-profit organizations or causes.
- **Freelancing-** Working independently on projects for various clients.

Building a career comes with, having the following elements:

- **Professional development-** ongoing learning, skill acquisition and advancement.
- **Identity-** How a person defines themselves in relation to their work.
- **Fulfillment-** The satisfaction and meaning derived from one's work.
- **Progression-** A path of advancement or growth within a field or industry.

Building a successful career is hard, and requires a lot time of work and continuous development, remember how discussed about competition, when your skills don't match the market standard or don't reach people's expectations it's definite that you will be replaced. In *The Diary of a CEO*, *Steven Bartlett* says it well; you should fill you five buckets orderly: Knowledge - Skills - Network - Resources - Reputation.

To build a strong career that will be worthwhile over the longer time of your life, you should acquire knowledge enough to equip you to work in that career, and learn skills to create abilities to build and get things done, then what you build, if it's amazing you will connect to people and grow your network among people who need your skills which will give access to many resources from this network and you can get paid, then ultimately your good work gives you a reputation which can build your identity to other people and keep attracting more people to work with you.

To keep your career alive, you need to maintain your knowledge and skills more, which means if you fall short of your skills in the long run your access to resources and reputation will come to a downfall, and that's why some jobs are replaced when some technology comes in and serves the people's needs more efficiently.

Which brings me to suggesting long-term learning which is very important because it is what will make you sustain your knowledge and skills, and the knowledge can be obtained from the internet, or other educational institutions like universities. So instead of working too hard on finding networks, make yourself valuable first, chase value and people will come to you if they need the skills you have or else you'll find yourself building resourceless networks.

BUILDING NETWORKS AND FRIENDSHIPS

Networking is essential for building a fulfilling life. As social beings, we crave connection. While introverts like me may find it better to work alone and get things done in a self-mannered way, meaningful relationships still hold value. A strong network is crucial for both career growth and a healthy social life.

Demographics play a significant role in where we find potential connections. People gather in specific places based on shared interests. For instance, gym-goers typically aim to improve their physical health, regardless of individual differences. So, it's not bad to say hi to people when you go to church and at least ask their name, and get to know them a bit.

Humans share approximately 90% of the same characteristics. The remaining 10%—cultural aspects and personal interests—sets us apart meaning we can still use the 90% similarity to at least form meaningful relationships and meaningful connections with people but I didn't say you should make friends with everyone, choose wisely cause your friends and people you choose to hang around with will definitely influence who you are and what you do. A supportive network can help you grow professionally and personally. Collaborating with individuals who excel in their fields can inspire and motivate you.

Beyond career benefits, building a social network is essential having work-related friends could constraint or limit your friendship to sharing a few things of your life, or how you spend your time. Forming friends on social media isn't ideal either it is stimulating but it doesn't provide intimacy. Most friendships are developed through work or school which makes sense but I find spontaneous(natural) approach to forming friendships can lead to mutual growth. Having many friends doesn't guarantee you happiness either. True happiness comes from within. Prioritize your well-being and build friendships that align with your needs and values, be happy even when you are alone and people change over time so your friends will change to and your priorities will shift as you each continue to grow and experience life from a different point-of-view and adopt different ideas or ideologies along the way meaning your friendship with people will evolve and again, all relationships at some point come to an end, either death will separate you, changes in ideologies or some will just outgrow the space and become the bigger person. Embrace these changes as they happen

Expect rejections as well from people, you can't connect with everyone but you can still connect with someone, when people say no it means they don't want you to be part of their story which is good because then you win and have the option to build your own story. And in case you fall into conflicts with friends, just speak them out and seek resolutions to work against the problem not against each other, unspoken expectations will eventually turn to resentments, set boundaries and speak in clarity with your friends. Don't be afraid to say you don't want that, not interested in or don't want to go, saying NO can upset many people like your friends but surely it will keep you away from doing what you don't want.

Focus on building strong relationships with a few trusted individuals, but keep private things to yourself, trust yourself more than anyone else, because faking friendships is quite easier and it is hard to hide hatred, so if someone clearly says they don't like you, it's awesome because they're making it easier and less confusing for you by showing you- **REALITY** unlike others who camouflage their intentions. Avoid unhealthy connections that drain your energy or hold you back. Choose yourself and prioritize your own well-being.

FINAL PIECE

Over the book, a lot has been written, and there is no way I'll be able to speak of everything rather we stick to the fundamentals, the ones that guide everything else. Connect the dots, it's up to you to step out of the confusion cloud, no one is going to come to save you! Build your own life story, build your philosophy, build a stable network and build thy self.

THE END